

tions undoubtedly gives home teams a winning edge. And on this count, nobody fares better than India, in India. In the period between the last World Cup in 2019 till now, India's win-loss ratio at home stands at a phenomenal 3.33 (winning 20 games and losing just 6). No team has an edge in head-to-head comparisons in ODIs played in India since 2019. And whilst the argument that the Indian Premier League (IPL) has helped foreign players get accustomed to Indian conditions does have merit, the stats are proof that India's home advantage is still an overwhelming proposition for most teams.

THE INFLEXIBILITY BROUGHT ON BY THE LACK OF GENUINE ALL-ROUNDERS IS A WORRY FOR INDIA. SO TOO THE DIP IN THEIR BIG GAME MENTALITY

Former Indian team member Harbhajan Singh explains in detail the technical advantage India gains when playing at home. "Indian batters pierce gaps better than other teams. That's primarily because they use the pace and bounce on home grounds better," says the 2011 World Cup winner. "While other teams like Australia and England have to take risks when looking for boundaries in India, our batters, familiar with the ground conditions, can accelerate the scoring rate without taking any. The effect is that we have more boundary-hitters in our team compared to any other." The Indian caravan will move across nine